

Gatekeeper Objections: Practice List

For: Mark and G-Anne | **Campaign:** RIA Outreach (Playbook v2)

Rule for every call: never hang up with nothing. Leave with a **transfer**, a **callback time**, a **direct line**, or an **email**.

Your mindset: the gatekeeper protects the owner's time. Be polite, short and confident. You are not pitching to them. You are asking for two minutes with the owner.

Before you dial (Playbook Section 3): check GHL and the lead source. Know if you're calling a **firm owner** or an **individual advisor**, and the person's first name.

Never say to a gatekeeper (Playbook Section 1): anything about selling, buying, merging or recruiting, any numbers, or who else we're talking to. Every owner conversation is confidential.

A. Screening questions

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
1	"What's this regarding?"	Give a short reason, then ask for the owner again.	One sentence only. Long answers sound like sales.
2	"Is this a sales call?"	Answer honestly, then give the real reason.	"No" alone sounds suspicious. Always say why you're calling.
3	"What company are you with? What do you do?"	Say who One Wealth Map is in one line.	Use the playbook line: a multi-family office with tax, estate, insurance and back office in-house.
4	"Does the owner know you? Are they expecting your call?"	Be honest and stay confident.	Never pretend to know the owner.
5	"How did you get this number?"	Give the real source.	Be honest. Confirm the wording with Sam first.
6	"Can I tell them what it's about?"	Share enough to be passed along.	"A confidential business matter" is enough. Save the details for the owner.

B. Owner not available

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
7	"They're with a client."	Get a specific callback time.	"Later" isn't a time. Offer two options and log it in GHL.
8	"They're out of the office this week."	Find out when they're back.	Ask for a day and time, not just "next week."
9	"They're in meetings all day, every day."	Find a gap in their day.	Ask when their day starts or ends. Owners are often free early or late.

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
10	"They don't take calls. Everything goes through me."	Make the gatekeeper your partner.	Ask how important matters usually reach the owner, then follow that process.

C. Brush-offs

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
11	"Send an email."	Get the owner's direct email, or a time to call.	Say yes, then ask for one more thing. Use the playbook email for the track.
12	"Send it to info@ and we'll pass it along."	Avoid the general inbox.	Politely ask for a direct address. If not, ask for a time.
13	"Leave a message and they'll call you back."	Leave a short message and set your own follow-up.	Don't wait for a callback. Ask when to try again.
14	"Just leave a voicemail."	Leave a voicemail under 20 seconds.	Use the playbook voicemail for the track. Say your number slowly, twice.
15	"We get calls like this all the time."	Show respect and stand out.	Agree with them, then keep the ask small: two minutes.

D. The gatekeeper decides

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
16	"They're not interested." (said for the owner)	Let the owner decide.	Don't argue. Ask if you can send one short note.
17	"I handle these decisions."	Find out if they're an owner or staff.	Ask kindly about their role. Ownership matters need the owner.
18	"We already have an advisor." / "We don't need services."	Clear up the confusion.	They may think you're selling to their clients. Explain it's a conversation for the owner, from our founder.
19	"We're not hiring." / "They're not looking for a job."	Stay calm and keep it confidential.	Don't argue or explain the offer to the gatekeeper. Just ask for the right person.
20	"We're not selling the firm."	Protect confidentiality.	Never discuss selling with staff. The owner's plans may be private.

E. Rules and restrictions

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
21	"We don't accept unsolicited calls. Remove us."	Exit politely and mark Do Not Call in GHL.	A polite exit is a win. It protects One Wealth Map's name.

#	They say	Goal	Coaching point
22	“Calls are recorded. They can’t discuss outside business on this line.”	Respect the rule and find another way.	Don’t fight compliance. Ask for an email or a better number.
23	“Our compliance team has to approve this.”	Learn their process.	Ask where to send information. Following it shows professionalism.
24	“We’re with a large broker-dealer. They can’t take these calls.”	Stay respectful and ask for another channel.	Never comment on their agreements. That’s for the principals.

F. Phone systems and wrong contacts

#	Situation	Goal	Coaching point
25	Phone menu (IVR) with no clear option	Reach a real person.	Try the directory by last name first, then “new clients.” Note what worked in GHL.
26	“There’s no one here by that name.”	Check if the data is wrong.	Ask who owns the firm now. Update GHL.
27	“They retired.” / “They left the firm.”	Find the new owner.	A recent change can mean the firm is in transition. Update GHL.
28	“They passed away.”	Respond with kindness and end the call.	Offer condolences. Don’t pitch. Note it in GHL.

G. Outside the box

#	Situation	Goal	Coaching point
29	The gatekeeper is chatty and friendly.	Build rapport and learn the owner’s schedule.	Ask their name and use it. A friendly gatekeeper is your best ally.
30	The gatekeeper is rude or hangs up.	Stay professional and try another day.	It’s not personal. Log it and try a different time.
31	“Can you hold?” (long hold)	Keep the call.	Prepare your opening while waiting. If it’s too long, ask for a callback time.
32	“Talk to our operations manager instead.”	Decide if that person can help.	Be polite. Ownership matters need the owner, but they may help you reach them.
33	The gatekeeper wants all the details.	Stay short without sounding secretive.	Share one line. The rest is confidential, for the owner.
34	Third callback, same gatekeeper	Turn repetition into familiarity.	Use their name and mention the last call. Polite persistence builds trust.
35	The owner answers unexpectedly.	Switch to owner mode right away.	Don’t freeze. Confirm their name, then go to the playbook opening.

Quick reminders

- **Use first names:** the owner's and the gatekeeper's.
- **Be short:** your reason fits in one sentence.
- **Be honest:** never pretend to know the owner or make up a reason.
- **Keep it confidential:** no deal talk, no numbers, no other firm names.
- **Always ask for one more thing:** a time, a direct line, or an email.
- **Log everything in GHL:** gatekeeper's name, best time, what worked.
- **Respect "remove us":** a polite exit is a professional win.